

WILD RAPHA

Meal Plan

Eat like you train. Consistent, not complicated.

My nutrition philosophy

You can do everything right:

hit your miles, nail your intervals, lift smart, sleep well.

But if you're under-eating calories and protein, you're starving the engine that keeps you strong. It stays small, fragile, easy to burn.

I learned this the hard way: after six months of heavy training, I lost 10 kg of muscle in just two months. Almost a full year of consistent gym work .. gone.

So let's make sure that never happens to you.



When you run far and lift heavy, your body's always balancing breakdown and rebuild.

Food is how you tip the scales your way. It's not complicated, but it has to be real.

|Here are some simple rules I follow:

I keep it simple:

- 80% of what you eat should be minimally processed, single-ingredient foods. Think meat, fish, eggs, seasonal veggies, fruits, roots, nuts, good oils.
- 20% is flexible — a piece of dark chocolate, fresh bread, your favorite comfort food. You're human. Enjoy it.
- Protein comes first. Aim for around 0.7–1 gram per pound of bodyweight (1.6–2.2g/kg) daily. It keeps you anabolic when running tries to break you down.
- Carbs support your miles. Eat more when you're building mileage or hitting hard sessions. Eat less when you're recovering.
- Healthy fats matter. They keep your hormones working, your recovery smooth, and your brain sharp.

Nutrition Basics for Runners

Your body is an engine: It burns fuel every minute of every day. If you don't give it enough, it'll break itself down to survive. Here's how the basics work:

DEFINITIONS

BMR (base metabolic rate)

This is your baseline burn. It's the calories your body needs just to keep you alive. Breathing, organs, brain ticking. Even if you lie in bed all day.

More muscle = higher BMR.

NEAT (non-exercise activity thermogenesis)

The secret burn. This is all the calories you use just living — walking, standing, fidgeting. It can make a huge difference in staying lean and strong.

TTDE (total daily energy expenditure)

Your TDEE is your real daily burn. It's your Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR), plus all the calories you use just living (NEAT), plus what you burn running and lifting. Most runners underestimate this.

If you run far but don't eat enough to cover your burn, your body breaks itself down — starting with your muscle.

You build muscle only when you fuel the engine with enough protein, calories, and strength training.

Run more? Eat more. Lift heavy? Eat more. Recover better? Eat enough.

CALCULATIONS

TTDE = BRM + NEAT + Exercise

My BMR: (baseline burn)

~1,800 kcal/day

+ My NEAT: (secret burn)

~500–800 kcal/day (walking, standing, daily movement)

+ EXERCISE:

~750 kcal (10 km run)

~300 kcal (Strength session)

= ~3,400 kcal/day

Category	Plan 1 (~2200 kcal)	Plan 2 (~2700 kcal)	Plan 3 (~3200 kcal)
Breakfast	3 scrambled eggs, ½ avocado, 2 slices sourdough, drizzle olive oil (500 kcal)	3 eggs, ½ avocado, 2 slices sourdough, small side of smoked salmon (600 kcal)	4 eggs, ½ avocado, 2 slices sourdough with butter, smoked salmon, small fruit bowl (700 kcal)
Snack	-	Greek yogurt + granola + banana slices + handful of nuts (500 kcal)	Greek yogurt, big handful berries, granola, nuts, small dark chocolate square (600–700 kcal)
Lunch	Large salad: grilled chicken breast, greens, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, feta, olive oil & seeds (600 kcal)	Big salad: grilled salmon, mixed greens, sweet potato chunks, seeds, olive oil, balsamic (700 kcal)	Big salad: double portion grilled chicken or salmon, quinoa, avocado, nuts & seeds, olive oil drizzle (800 kcal)
Snack	Greek yogurt, handful of mixed berries, small handful of nuts (400 kcal)	1 rice cake + nut butter + 1 boiled egg (150–200 kcal)	2 rice cakes with nut butter + handful trail mix or ½ protein bar (200–250 kcal)
Dinner	Salmon fillet, quinoa, steamed broccoli, drizzle olive oil (600 kcal)	Lean beef or turkey mince, rice, roasted root veggies (750 kcal)	Large portion salmon or lean beef, roasted sweet potato or rice, sautéed greens (800 kcal)
Macros	CALORIES (~2,200) - PROTEIN: ~160g - CARBS: ~210g - FAT: ~70g	CALORIES (~2,700) - PROTEIN: ~170g - CARBS: ~260g - FAT: ~80g	CALORIES (~3,200) - PROTEIN: ~180g - CARBS: ~320g - FAT: ~100g

Simple Snacks That Keep You Strong

Title: Simple Snacks That Keep You Strong

When you’re training hard, what you eat between meals matters as much as the meals themselves.
Here are a few real, high-protein snacks that fuel recovery and keep hunger under control. No fancy powders needed.

Snack	Protein	Why it’s great
Greek yogurt + honey + seeds	20g	Fast digesting, balances gut health
Canned tuna + olive oil + crackers	25g	Pure protein, salty, portable
2 boiled eggs + avocado	14g	Healthy fats + full amino profile
Cottage cheese + fruit	18g	Slow-digesting protein, great before bed
Protein bar (≥20g, low sugar)	20g	Quick option on the go
Trail mix with nuts & beef jerky	15g	Combo of protein + fats for endurance

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